

Evan Mobley (Order #29860615)

CHAPTER 7

ENVIRONMENT

This chapter rounds out the rules with guidelines for handling miscellany like disasters, hazards, hostile environments, and toxins. It also includes rules concerning feats of superheroic strength and power. While we can't address every possible scenario, the goal of this chapter is to provide a frame of reference to help you adjudicate situations that aren't in the rules.

DISASTERS

Heroes don't just fight evil. With your unique abilities, you are often called on to help the victims of natural and manufactured disasters. Events like avalanches, broken dams, burning buildings, collapsing structures, earthquakes, flash floods, mudslides, power plant failures, plummeting airplanes, rockslides, runaway trains, sinking ships, tidal waves, tornadoes, tsunamis, volcanic eruptions, and wildfires offer more than enough to worry about, even if the bad guys have taken the day off.

Battling a disaster is broken up into a number of goals. Minor disasters have 3 goals, while major ones have 9 goals. A goal is anything you need to accomplish to improve the situation: saving people, diverting floodwaters, fighting fires, supporting collapsing buildings, and so on. Most goals can be accomplished with a good idea and a successful challenge roll. Occasionally, however, a goal might be important enough to demand its own scene. This is up to the GM. The GM usually comes up with 2 of the goals in a minor disaster or 6 of the goals in a major disaster, leaving you and your fellow Heroes to brainstorm the others. Once all goals have been accomplished or failed, check the **Disaster Results** table to determine who narrates the resolution and aftermath of the disaster.

ENERGY

Although there are many different kinds of energy in the real world, P&P lumps them into a few simple categories for game purposes — otherwise Powers that control or resist energy become too diluted. The basic types of energy are described on the **Energy Types** table. Because gravity and magnetism are forces that affect physical objects directly, they should be represented with Powers like Elemental Control and Telekinesis. If you must classify these forces as energy, treat them both as force energy.

FALLING

Falls are treated like attacks that can only be resisted with passive defenses (unless you can come up with a creative way to use an active defense instead). The attack rank of a fall depends on the distance fallen, as shown on the **Falling** table. Increase the attack rank by 3d if you land on something like spikes or sharp rocks; lower it by 3d if you land on something like cushions, garbage, or water. Additionally, whenever you fall onto soft surfaces like these, you can use Agility as an active defense against falling damage.

DISASTER RESULTS

MINOR	MAJOR	RESULTS
0 Goals Accomplished	0 or 1 Goal Accomplished	GM
1 Goal Accomplished	2 to 4 Goals Accomplished	GM with Embellishment
2 Goals Accomplished	5 to 7 Goals Accomplished	Players with Embellishment
3 Goals Accomplished	8 or 9 Goals Accomplished	Players

ENERGY TYPES

ENERGY	DESCRIPTION
Acid/Corrosive	Chemical energy that dissolves matter, usually in a physical medium.
Arcane/Otherworldly	Pure magical energy of the physical (as opposed to mental) variety.
Cold/Frost/Ice	Considered a unique kind of energy in most settings.
Electricity/Lightning	If it looks like lightning, it probably falls under this category.
Energy/Laser	Generic energy: light, lasers, and anything not otherwise covered.
Fire/Heat/Plasma	Anything that involves heat; some overlap with generic energy above.
Force/Kinetic	Physical force: attacks using this energy are considered physical attacks.
Cosmic Energy/Radiation	Comic book radiation that works like energy, not the real stuff.
Sound/Thunder/Vibration*	Sonic or vibratory energy, the energy of molecular motion.

**If you care, this kind of energy should be useless in a vacuum but at +3d when used underwater.*

Evan Mobley (Order: 29850615)

FALLING

DISTANCE	RANK
Up to 10 Feet	4d
Up to 25 Feet	6d
Up to 50 Feet	8d
Up to 100 Feet	10d
Up to 250 Feet	11d
Any Farther	12d

HOSTILE ENVIRONMENTS

Hostile environments can subject you to hazards like extreme pressure and temperature, ionizing radiation, and toxic atmospheres. Pressure extremes can range from the crushing pressure at the bottom of the ocean to the complete vacuum of space. Ionizing radiation may be found in and around nuclear power plants and blast sites, as well as in outer space. And toxic atmospheres filled with corrosive or poisonous gases exist right here on Earth, as well as on any number of alien worlds.

Environmental hazards are either minor or major. A **minor hazard** might be a smoke-filled room, low-level radiation, extreme temperatures, and so on. You can withstand exposure to minor hazards for a number of minutes equal to your Toughness; after that, you suffer 1 point of damage per minute of exposure. **Major hazards** include things like crushing undersea pressure, high-level radiation, and the vacuum of outer space. Exposure to these conditions is measured in pages rather than minutes, so even if you aren't in combat you should track time in pages when dealing with a major hazard. You can withstand exposure to major hazards for a number of pages equal to your Toughness; after that, you suffer 1 point of damage per page of exposure. Hazards can't inflict more than 1 point of damage per page, even if you're exposed to multiple hazards at the same time. Certain Powers (notably Adaptation and Immunity) can protect you against environmental hazards.

SUFFOCATION

You can hold your breath for a number of minutes equal to your Toughness. After that, you start suffering 1 point of damage per page until you can breathe again. Once you can breathe normally, all suffocation damage immediately goes away. As usual, you'll be defeated rather than killed if you suffer too much damage unless you're playing a game in which Heroes can die. Assuming you aren't, you and your GM are going to have to figure out how you managed to survive.

SWIMMING

Characters travel only half as fast as normal and use half their Agility when making movement-related challenge rolls while swimming. They also suffer a –3d penalty to Perception rolls while underwater. A scuba mask lowers this penalty to –1d for visual Perception rolls. When engaging in underwater combat, characters use half their Edge and suffer a –3d penalty to their physical attack and active defense rolls. As you might expect, characters with Swimming ignore these penalties. Deep water is dark, very cold, and can expose characters to pressure extremes and the risks associated with sudden changes in pressure, but those real world complexities are left for GMs to handle or ignore as they see fit.

LEAPING

Distances are intentionally abstract in P&P, but it can sometimes be helpful to have a more concrete idea of how far you can jump. All characters effectively have Leaping at half their Might for purposes of determining how far they can jump. However, you need to have spent Hero Points on Leaping if you want to use the Power as a means of long-distance travel.

LIFTING

The maximum amount of weight you can lift is normally a static value that depends on your Might, but this assumes optimal conditions. Lifting a heavy object can be tricky when rushed or too distracted to get a good grip on the thing. That being the case, whenever you want to lift a heavy object in combat or during other fast-paced actions scenes, the GM may ask for a Might roll to see if you can manage it. The threshold for this roll depends on the object's weight, as shown on the **Lifting** table.

LIFTING

WEIGHT	EXAMPLES	THRESHOLD
Under 100 Pounds	Scooter, Wolf	1
100 Pounds to 500 Pounds	Motorcycle, Lion	2
500 Pounds to 1 Ton	Car, Bear	3
1 Ton to 5 Tons	Truck, Hippo	4
5 Tons to 25 Tons	Lear Jet, Elephant	5
25 Tons to 100 Tons	Commercial Jet, Blue Whale	6
100 Tons to 500 Tons	Jumbo Jet	7
500 Tons to 2 Kilotons	Small Freighter	8
2 Kilotons to 10 Kilotons	Frigate	9
10 Kilotons to 50 Kilotons	Battleship, Small Building	10
50 Kilotons to 250 Kilotons	Aircraft Carrier, Tall Building	11
250 Kilotons to 1 Megaton	Skyscraper	12

Evan Mobley (Order: 29850615)

SCORCHING

Heat and electricity are common sources of harm. Like falling, whenever you are exposed to either energy, you suffer an attack that can only be resisted with passive defenses (unless you can come up with a creative way of using one of your active defenses instead). Use the **Scorching** table as a guide when determining the rank of such attacks.

SCORCHING

HEAT	ELECTRICITY	RANK
Campfire	Wall Socket	4d
Building Fire	Car Battery	6d
Chemical Fire	Power Line	8d
Incinerator	Power Main	10d
Lava	Generator	11d
Blast Furnace	Lightning	12d

SMASHING

What would this game be without rules for smashing things? Depressing, that's what. Luckily, we're here for you. While vehicles and complex machines have a Body characteristic, simple objects like doors and walls have a **Structure** rank that determines their durability. The Structure of common materials is on the **Smashing** table. GMs can raise or lower an object's Structure by 1d to 4d depending on its condition, thickness, and whatever other factors they deem relevant.

SMASHING

MATERIAL	STRUCTURE
Cloth, Drywall, Glass, Ice, Rope	2d
Plastic, Rubber, Wood	4d
Brick, Bulletproof Glass, Hardwood	6d
Asphalt, Concrete, Machinery	8d
Iron, Stone	10d
Steel	12d
Diamond, Titanium	14d
Advanced Alloy, Magical Metal	18d
Ozymandium Alloy*	24d

**Most comic book worlds have at least one substance that's all but invulnerable to physical harm. In the Pinnacle City Universe, that metal is Ozymandium — Metal of Metals! — and it's impervious only in its pure form. While not unbreakable, Ozymandium alloys are incredibly strong and resilient.*

Whenever you want to bend, break, or smash through an object, make a challenge roll using Might or one of your Powers against the object's Structure. You can bend or make a small hole in an object with 1 to 2 net successes, but big holes require 3 or more net successes. You must do this all at once; you can't combine net successes over multiple attempts. In fact, if an object is especially thick — like castle wall thick — the GM might make you do this a few times in order to smash through it completely.

Evan Mobley (Order: 29850615)

DAMAGING COVER

Attacks can penetrate objects used as cover if their attack rank exceeds the object's Structure. Any time you attack a target by smashing or shooting through an object, the target can use the object's Structure as a passive defense. When combined with the above rules for smashing objects, what this means is that you have two options when attacking a target hiding behind cover. If your attack rank exceeds the cover's Structure, you can shoot right through it. If not, you can try to smash a hole in the object your target is hiding behind, after which they'll presumably be more exposed.

SCENERY AS WEAPONS

Super strong characters tend to use anything they can find as weapons. Can you blame them? If you use a heavy object or a vehicle as a club, you get a +1d bonus to your close combat attack rolls. If you use a heavy object or a vehicle as a thrown projectile, this allows you to use Might +1d to perform a ranged attack, which is nice when you have superhuman strength.

Unfortunately, mundane objects can take only so much punishment before becoming confetti. Whenever you use a mundane object as an improvised weapon, your attack rank caps out at the object's Body or Structure plus 6d. For example, motorcycles have 5d Body, so you can't roll more than 11d when using one as an improvised weapon. Similarly, most wooden telephone poles have 7d Structure (6d plus 1d for thickness), so you can't roll more than 13d when using one as an improvised weapon.

Because everyday objects like streetlights, telephone poles, and cars aren't designed to be used as weapons, they don't last long under this kind of punishment. For every page that an everyday object is used as a weapon by a super strong character, its effective Body or Structure is reduced by 2d for these purposes. Again, this only applies when super strong characters use scenery and vehicles as weapons. A character with normal human strength can wield an iron crowbar until the cows come home without affecting the thing in any way. Edge cases are up to the GM's discretion.

SCENERY

PIECE OF SCENERY	BODY / STRUCTURE	MAX ATTACK RANK
Post Office Mailbox	4d	10d
Heavy Door, Motorcycle	5d	11d
Brick Wall, Telephone Pole	6d	12d
Metal Dumpster, Sedan, Statue	7d	13d
Big Statue, Fighter Jet, Humvee	8d	14d
747 Airliner, Bus, Huge Tree, Yacht	9d	15d
18-Wheeler, Giant Statue	10d	16d
Ferris Wheel, Tank	11d	17d
Vault Door	12d	18d

MASSIVE OBJECTS

If you can manage to heft a truly massive object and somehow keep it from falling apart under its own weight, it works as described above, only using the object's weight rank instead of its Body or Structure. Unlike ordinary scenery, massive objects always break apart after the first shot.

MASSIVE OBJECTS

MASSIVE OBJECT	WEIGHT RANK	MAX ATTACK RANK
Statue of Liberty	14d	20d
Freight Train	16d	22d
Destroyer, Eiffel Tower, Freighter	18d	24d
The London Eye	19d	25d
Aircraft Carrier, Ocean Liner	21d	27d
Skyscraper	22d	28d
Empire State Building	23d	29d
Burj Khalifa, Golden Gate Bridge	24d	30d
The Great Pyramid	26d	32d
Mount Everest	40d	46d
Moon	63d	69d
Earth	69d	75d

TOXINS

Biological and chemical agents like diseases, drugs, and poisons are **toxins**. Toxins work like Powers with an Innate Source. Once a character is exposed to a toxin, they can only use their passive defenses — normally Toughness or the Resistance Power — to resist its effects. The following Pros and Cons apply only to mundane diseases, drugs, and poisons (unless the GM rules otherwise).

CAUSTIC

CON –2 Hero Points

This applies only to the Stun Power. A character affected by the Power isn't incapacitated, but instead suffers a –2d penalty to all challenge rolls for the Power's duration. If the Power comes in the form of a gas, it attacks everyone in its area of effect at the start of each page.

LETHAL DISEASE

PRO +6 Hero Points

This applies only to the Slay Power. Any damage inflicted by the Power isn't inflicted immediately. Instead, the character is incapacitated until the end of the current issue, at which time the damage is inflicted. The GM will have to determine whether the character can be cured before then — and at what threshold — on a case-by-case basis. Last, these symptoms may take days or weeks to appear.

Evan Mobley (Order: 29850615)

NON-LETHAL DISEASE

PRO +2 Hero Points

This applies only to the Stun Power. A character affected by the Power isn't incapacitated, but instead suffers a –2d penalty to all challenge rolls for the rest of the current issue. The GM will have to determine whether the character can be cured before then — and at what threshold — on a case-by-case basis. Last, these symptoms may take days or weeks to appear.

DISEASES

TOXIN	POWER
Anthrax	Slay 5d (Lethal Disease, Toxin)
Bubonic Plague	Slay 6d (Lethal Disease, Toxin)
Common Cold	Stun 3d (Non-Lethal Disease, Toxin)
Ebola	Slay 7d (Lethal Disease, Toxin)
Influenza	Stun 5d (Non-Lethal Disease, Toxin)
Malaria	Stun 6d (Non-Lethal Disease, Toxin)
Malaria, Severe	Slay 2d (Lethal Disease, Toxin)
Smallpox	Slay 3d (Lethal Disease, Toxin)
Staph Infection*	Slay 4d (Lethal Disease, Toxin)

**Includes various bacterial infections, such as those resulting from open wounds or untreated injuries.*

DRUGS AND POISONS

TOXIN	POWER
Alcohol, Too Much	Stun 6d (Caustic, Toxin)
Alcohol, Way Too Much	Stun 6d (Toxin)
Ancient Poison*	Slay 5d (Toxin)
Anesthesia	Stun 10d (Toxin)
Blowfish Toxin	Slay 7d (Toxin)
Cyanide	Slay 9d (Toxin)
Knockout Drops	Stun 6d (Toxin)
Knockout Gas	Stun 8d (Toxin)
Laughing Gas	Drain (Intellect, Willpower) 6d (Toxin)
Mustard Gas	Slay 4d & Stun 8d (Caustic, Toxin)
Nerve Gas	Slay 11d (Toxin)
Pepper Spray	Stun 6d (Caustic, Toxin)
Strychnine	Slay 5d (Toxin)
Tear Gas	Stun 6d (Caustic, Toxin)
Tranquilizer	Stun 6d (Toxin)
Truth Serum	Drain (Intellect, Willpower) 8d (Toxin)
Venom, Lethal	Slay 3d to 7d (Toxin)
Venom, Paralytic	Stun 4d to 8d (Toxin)

**Includes various naturally derived poisons such as arsenic, belladonna, hemlock, and curare.*



Evan Mobley (Order: 29850615)